On His Own, With a Hand, Not Sure

A worksheet for writing down Dad's everyday routines, with today's date on it.

“Dad's doing fine” is true, and next year it won't tell you much about this year. “Tuesday: made his own breakfast, did a load of laundry, walked to the mailbox and back” is something you can set a later Tuesday beside.

Fill this in over a couple of ordinary weeks, with Dad if he'd like to. Write what happened, with the day. If nobody has seen something and Dad hasn't mentioned it, write “not sure” and leave it. Put the date on the last line. A page with a date on it is one you can compare against.

In his own words

Ask Dad what's easy, what takes a bit longer than it used to, and where a hand is welcome. Write what he says, the way he says it.

FOR EXAMPLE “I do everything I always did. The lawn takes me two goes now, and I don't mind that.”

On his own

Bathing, dressing, eating, using the bathroom, getting around, and the everyday jobs that go with them. Only what someone has seen or Dad has told you.

FOR EXAMPLE Thursday: showered and dressed before I arrived. Made us both lunch. Took the stairs to fetch his glasses.

With a hand, and whose

The help that already happens, including the small things nobody counts any more. Add roughly when each one began, if anyone remembers.

FOR EXAMPLE Appointments: my sister drives him, since about two winters ago. Heavy shopping: I bring it on Saturdays. Not sure when that started.

Not sure

The parts of his week nobody in the family has seen and Dad hasn't talked about. Don't guess. A blank you can see is more useful than a guess.

FOR EXAMPLE None of us is there in the evenings. We don't know what he usually has for supper.

What seems different from a year or two ago

One specific thing that happened, with a rough date. Leave out what you think it means.

FOR EXAMPLE March: missed a dentist appointment and rebooked it himself. That's the only time we know of.

Who filled this in, and the date

Next to anything that came from someone else, write their name.

What this shows you

Three things: what Dad does on his own, where a hand already happens, and what nobody is sure about. It doesn't show whether anything has changed, and nothing here adds up to a score or a level. It's a dated page to set the next one beside. If something on it raises a question, the question goes to his doctor or the other professionals who know him.

Ready for the next step?

You've put a date on how Dad manages his everyday routines. The care interview carries on where this page stops: it asks about each area of his daily life in order, keeps a source and a date with every answer, and builds a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›